

higher tolerance is more lenient, letting you select a wider range of colour, while a lower tolerance is much more specific.

The Anti-Alias option, which is on by default, prevents jagged edges when you make alterations to a selection. When the Contiguous option is on, only connected areas are selected; if you turn it off, then *all* areas of the image with similar colours are selected.

The Sample All Layers option tells the wand to make the selection based on all layers of the image rather than just the active layer, which it uses by default.

3.3.2 Selecting Colour Ranges

Quite similar to the Magic Wand, but much more powerful is the Colour Ranges dialog, found in the Select Menu.

In the **Select > Colour Range** dialog box, you can use the given drop-down menu to choose how the selection is going to be made. By default, the option is Sample Colour. You can use the Eyedropper tool to choose which colour range to select. Drag the Fuzziness slider to the left or right to contract or expand the range of colours that will finally be selected.

You will see a black-and-white preview of your selection—the white parts indicate the selection, and the black parts indicate complete exclusion from the selection. Due to the fuzziness option, you will also see some grey regions—these are partially-selected regions, and any effect that you apply to them will only affect them partially, as opposed to the fully white regions.

You can even add or subtract colours from your current selection using the eyedropper marked with a Plus or Minus sign respectively.

Using the Select drop-down menu, you can also select reds, yellows, blues, and other colours from the image. In addition, you can even select highlights, shadows or midtones from the image.